

Dry & Flaky Scalp

Background

- Completed isotretinoin (Accutane) treatment around April 2026; now October 2026 (about 5 to 6 months post-treatment)

Main concerns

- Scalp is much drier than before Accutane, with many flakes
- Hair texture has changed: much drier than before treatment
- Mild to moderate itch is present but not severe at baseline

Pattern of symptoms

- Mostly fine when indoors. Hair looks good and is not very frizzy after I style it post-shower
- Symptoms flare consistently when I go outside, in any weather but worst in mild to hot heat or bright sun
- During flares: itchy tingling sensations across the whole scalp, strong itching, more flakes, and heavy frizz with my hair changing shape
- It feels like I'm reacting to something outdoors (sun, heat/sweat, pollen, or humidity are possibilities)
- I've noticed when it's night with no sun my hair is fine, but when there is bright sun it gets lots of super itchy tingles

What I've tried

- Head & Shoulders Clinical Anti-Dandruff Shampoo: short-term relief, no noticeable improvement long-term
- Moisturizing conditioners: short-term relief, no noticeable improvement long-term
- Trying now: Dove DermaCare Scalp Dryness & Itch Relief shampoo (pyrithione zinc), so far there is no noticeable improvement

Not yet known / to check

- Whether this is dry scalp, seborrheic dermatitis/dandruff (yeast), sun or UV sensitivity, or allergy, or a mix

Things I don't have

- No redness of the scalp
- No waxy or yellow flakes
- No flakes around the eyebrows, sides of the nose, or behind the ears
- No itchy eyes, sneezing, or runny nose outdoors

Questions for the doctor

- Could this be lingering post-isotretinoin dryness or photosensitivity?
- Could seborrheic dermatitis or a yeast component be involved?
- Could an environmental allergy be contributing?
- What shampoo, treatment, or sun protection do you recommend for my scalp?
- How long might it take for my scalp and hair to return to normal?